

click noise, tactile feedback etc. Getting used to a mechanical keyboard takes time but it is quite worth it.

4. Having gold plated contacts on the USB or PS/2 port prevents corrosion but other than that there is no advantage to having them.
5. Wires with braiding are good if you are going to be flexing it a lot, otherwise it is a luxury.
6. If having macros will be a boon with your work then go for it.
7. When going in for a keyboard with backlighting, ensure that the brightness can be adjusted.
8. Go for a PS/2 keyboard when you have a PS/2 port available since you'll save a USB port.
9. Wireless keyboards do have issues with latency so avoid those when gaming.

Mouse

Tracking technology

There are three prominent motion tracking technology in use today. Tracking is basically how the mouse figures out in which direction the mouse is being moved in 2D space. The common forms of tracking technology are as follows.

Optical - These mice use an LED to illuminate the surface and another sensor rapidly takes images of the surface as the mouse is moved over a surface. By comparing these images with each other the mouse can plot the position of the cursor. Optical mice require that the surface be opaque as it depends upon the reflected light to capture the images. This is why most optical mice won't track properly or track at all on clear thick glass.

Laser - Similar to optical mice but with a minor difference, the laser mouse uses a coherent beam to track the surface, this makes the mouse track on glass surfaces and even at a significant distance from the surface, i.e. you could probably lift the mice above the surface about an inch or so and it will still track.

Trackball - Originally all mice were of this form and consisted of a weighted ball that made contact with the surface. This ball as it moved across the surface also rotated two axle in the body. Each axle corresponded to the horizontal and vertical axis. This way the distance a mouse moved along each axis was measured and the combination of these values was used to plot the position on the mouse cursor. The trackball in its own had two variants, with the trackball on the bottom and the other with the trackball